

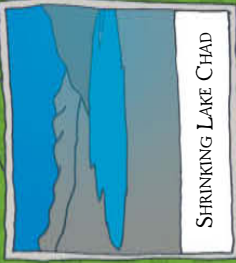
Central Africa

Extending from the hot, dry Sahara in the north down to the hot, wet, tropical rain forests of Cameroon and Gabon in the south, Central Africa has extensive oil and mineral reserves and some striking wildlife.

Chad

Chad shares its name with the shrinking lake where Cameroon, Niger, Nigeria, and Chad all meet. Due to serious droughts, Lake Chad today is just a tenth of its original size.

That's a serious situation.



This is my log book.

Cameroon

Heavily wooded Cameroon boasts quality hardwoods, such as ebony, mahogany, and teak, which are greatly sought after by Western furniture-makers.

I'm just going with the flow.

Central African Republic

Landlocked with few roads and no railways, the Central African Republic largely relies on the Ubangi River as its main transportation link, which flows along the southern border of the country to join the Congo River.

Equatorial Guinea

This tiny country is mainly tropical rain forest and consists of five offshore islands and a rectangle of land between Cameroon and Gabon.

Gabon

Two-thirds of Gabon is untouched tropical rain forest, and huge national parks have been set up to protect this important habitat.

Sao Tome and Principe

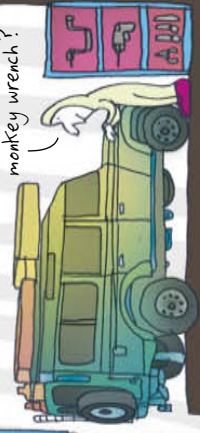
Largely volcanic, this two-island republic depends on cocoa exports for almost all its income.

What's that monkey's business?

East Africa

The five nations of East Africa boast some of the finest wildlife in Africa, with massive game reserves that attract tourists from all around the world.

Where's the monkey wrench?



Kenya

Thousands of tourists visit Kenya each year to view the spectacular array of wild animals in their natural habitats.



This is wild!

Somalia

The Boswellia trees that grow in northern Somalia are an important source of frankincense—a resin used to make expensive incense and perfume.

Smells lovely.

Horn of Africa

So-named because it is shaped like an animal's horn, the Horn of Africa is the easternmost part of the continent's mainland, jutting out into the Indian Ocean. It is largely desert, although Ethiopia and Eritrea are both mountainous.

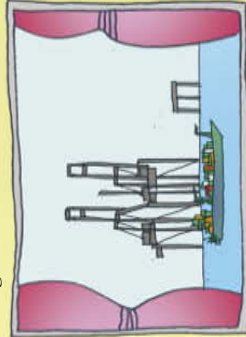
Ethiopia

One of the oldest Christian nations on Earth, Ethiopia possesses 11 remarkable cross-shaped churches, each cut out of the solid rock and dating back to the 1200s.



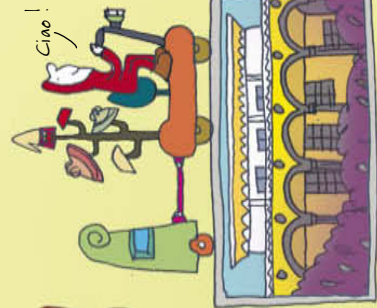
Djibouti

Unusually, Djibouti is named after its capital city, which is a major port in the Red Sea.



Eritrea

Asmara, Eritrea's capital, boasts many fine Italian-style modern buildings, built when it was an Italian colony during the 20th century.



Democratic Republic of Congo

This vast, tropical nation has massive mineral wealth, with large quantities of coltan, which is essential for the production of mobile phones.

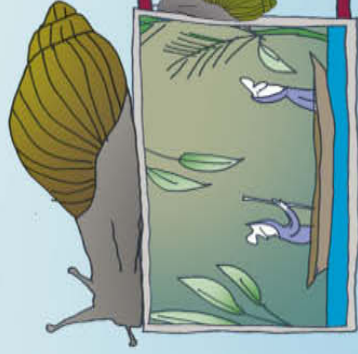
Hello? Can you hear me now?



The Congo Valley

The Congo is Africa's second-longest river after the Nile. For most of its length, this mainly wide, voluminous river has no rapids or waterfalls, making it easily navigable as well as a great source of fish.

This is a room with a view!



Congo

The smaller and more northern of the two nations that share a name, Congo is home to some extraordinary wildlife, including the immense Giant African Snail, which can grow up to 13in (33cm) long.

